

Outlook

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Test the mule hypothesis without labelling the customer

Hi team,

Financial Crime wants to test whether rapid receipt and onward movement forms a network pattern or reflects ordinary customer behaviour.

We looked at a version of this before. For the December 2020 review, please show what changed and whether the earlier conclusion still holds. The discussion is currently being driven by anecdotes, and the teams involved are describing the same customers differently.

Can you test these explanations rather than choosing one at the start?

- new accounts act as pass-through accounts
- shared beneficiaries connect otherwise separate customers
- salary, family support or business cash flow explains the pattern

The decision is which cases deserve investigation and which monitoring rule needs a better peer group. Please give us a Power BI page with drill-through to a reproducible case list.

You should be able to build the evidence from transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; monthly customer and KYC snapshots; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations. The output is a triage hypothesis. Do not label a customer a mule without investigation and external evidence.

Thanks